



◀ MANUFACTURE NATIONALE D'ARMES DE TULLE (MAT) 49

Date 1950s

Origin France

Barrel 9in (23cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The MAT 49's distinctive feature is its pivoting magazine housing; in addition to making the weapon easier to conceal, it's a very positive safety device because it takes the magazine out of the firing position. The gun saw widespread combat use during the First Indochina War (1946-54) and the Algerian War (1954-62), as well as in the 1956 Suez Crisis.



▲ UZI

Date 1950s

Origin Israel

Barrel 10½in (26cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The secret of the UZI's legendary stability lies in its bolt being wrapped around its barrel; this brings the center of gravity forward and helps to cure the tendency for the barrel to rise during automatic fire. Heavy moving parts keep its rate of fire to a manageable 600 rounds per minute.



► SKORPION VZ61

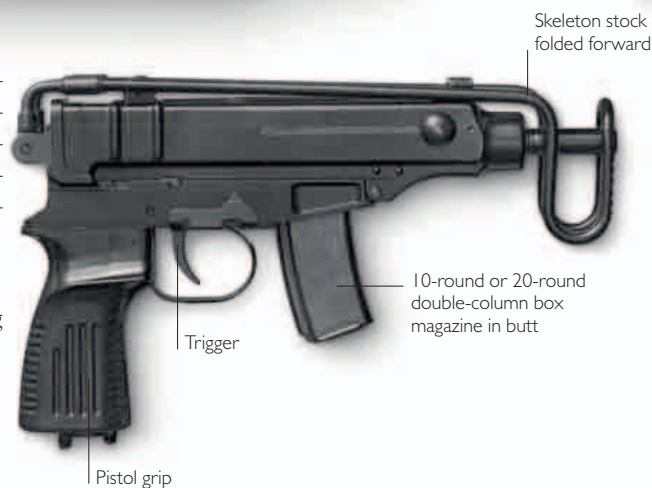
Date 1959

Origin Czechoslovakia

Barrel 4½in (11.43cm)

Caliber 7.65mm

The VZ61, or Skorpion, submachine-gun was designed by Miroslav Rybar. It was intended for use by security personnel and police. By incorporating a telescoping bolt, Rybar was able to produce a weapon that was short overall, so it was ideal for use in cramped spaces or for carrying beneath clothing. Its vertically folding stock further minimized its length.



▲ STECHKIN APS

Date 1960s

Origin USSR

Barrel 5in (12.7cm)

Caliber 9mm Makarov

The Stechkin was an unsuccessful attempt to produce a fully automatic pistol for use by security forces. Like the Makarov (see p.264), it was an unlocked recoil design based on the American Walther PP. In automatic mode, firing 750 rounds per minute, it was virtually uncontrollable.

